Advanced Policy Analysis
Family in Macroeconomics

Course instructor: Sagiri Kitao
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Office location: B910
Office hour: by appointment
Class term & time: 2024 Spring I and II (April-July) 13:20-14:50
Lecture classroom: H

1. Course Description and the Learning Objectives

This is an advanced topic course for Ph.D. students, ***who have already taken advanced macro 1-2 and advanced micro 1-2 as pre-requisites.***

The purpose of the course is to learn current research on family and macroeconomics, to acquire skills to construct theoretical and quantitative models in the topic, and to formulate your own research question and write a research proposal.

We will first spend several lectures to review various data on family and macroeconomics, and study theoretical and quantitative models based on selected papers. Second, students are asked to present recent papers from the reading list, and we constructively and critically examine their contributions and what remains to be investigated. Non-presenters are expected to actively participate in the discussion. Third, students start identifying and formulating a research question that interests them with the goal of writing a term paper in the form of a research proposal. Students are asked to present their research proposals in class.

The research proposal should be 10 to 15 pages in length on a theme related to the topic of the course. It should consist of a clearly defined research question, a summary of related literature, and the proposed strategy to answer the research question.

2. Course Outline

The preliminary schedule below is subject to changes and will be updated as we progress. There will be assigned readings for each topic.

Part I : Lectures on family macro

- Week 1-2: Introduction. Overview of family data and macro models of family
- Week 3-4: Family labor supply and fiscal policy
- Week 5-6: Fertility, marriage, and family dynamics
- Week 7: Demographic aging, macroeconomy, and fiscal sustainability
- Week 8-9: Education, bequests and intergenerational linkage

Part II : Student presentations and research projects

Week 10: Short presentations of research ideas

Week 11-13: Paper presentations

Week 14-15: Presentation of research proposals

3. Grading

60% Class presentations:

- Presentations: research idea (short), paper presentation, research proposal
- Active class participation (comments and questions) and contribution to general class discussions

40% Research proposal

4. Textbooks and References

There is no required textbook. The reading list will be distributed in class. Following survey papers and books are useful references and some of them will be covered in class.

On family and macroeconomics

- Doepke, M. and M. Tertilt (2016) "Families in Macroeconomics," chapter in Handbook of Macroeconomics, Vol. 2B, Chapter 23, Elsevier.
- Greenwood, J., N. Guner and R. Marto (2023) "The Great Transition: Kuznets Facts for Family-Economists," Handbook of the Economics of the Family, Elsevier.
- Greeenwood, J., N. Guner and G. Vandenbroucke (2017) "Family Economics Writ Large," Journal of Economic Literature, Vol. 55, No. 4, pp. 1346-1434.
- *Handbook of the Economics of the Family* Vol. 1 (2023) Ed. By Lundberg and Voena, North Holland.
- Greenwood, J. (2018) *Evolving Households: The Imprint of Technology on Life,* MIT Press.

On macroeconomics at the phD level

Ljungqvist and Sargent (2018) Recursive Macroeconomic Theory, 4th Ed., MIT Press.

On quantitative methods and computation

Heer and Maussner (2009) Dynamic General Equilibrium Modeling, 2nd Ed., Springer.

QuantEcon Online Resources: https://quantecon.org/

5. Auditing

Auditing is allowed upon permission of the instructor. ***Auditors must have taken advanced macro 1-2 and advanced micro 1-2, or their equivalence***. In principle, auditors are expected to attend all lectures and fulfill the same requirements as registered students.